



Universität
Zürich^{UZH}

Department of Informatics
Dynamic and Distributed Systems

Recommendations for the Recommenders

Reflections on Prioritizing Diversity in the RecSys Challenge

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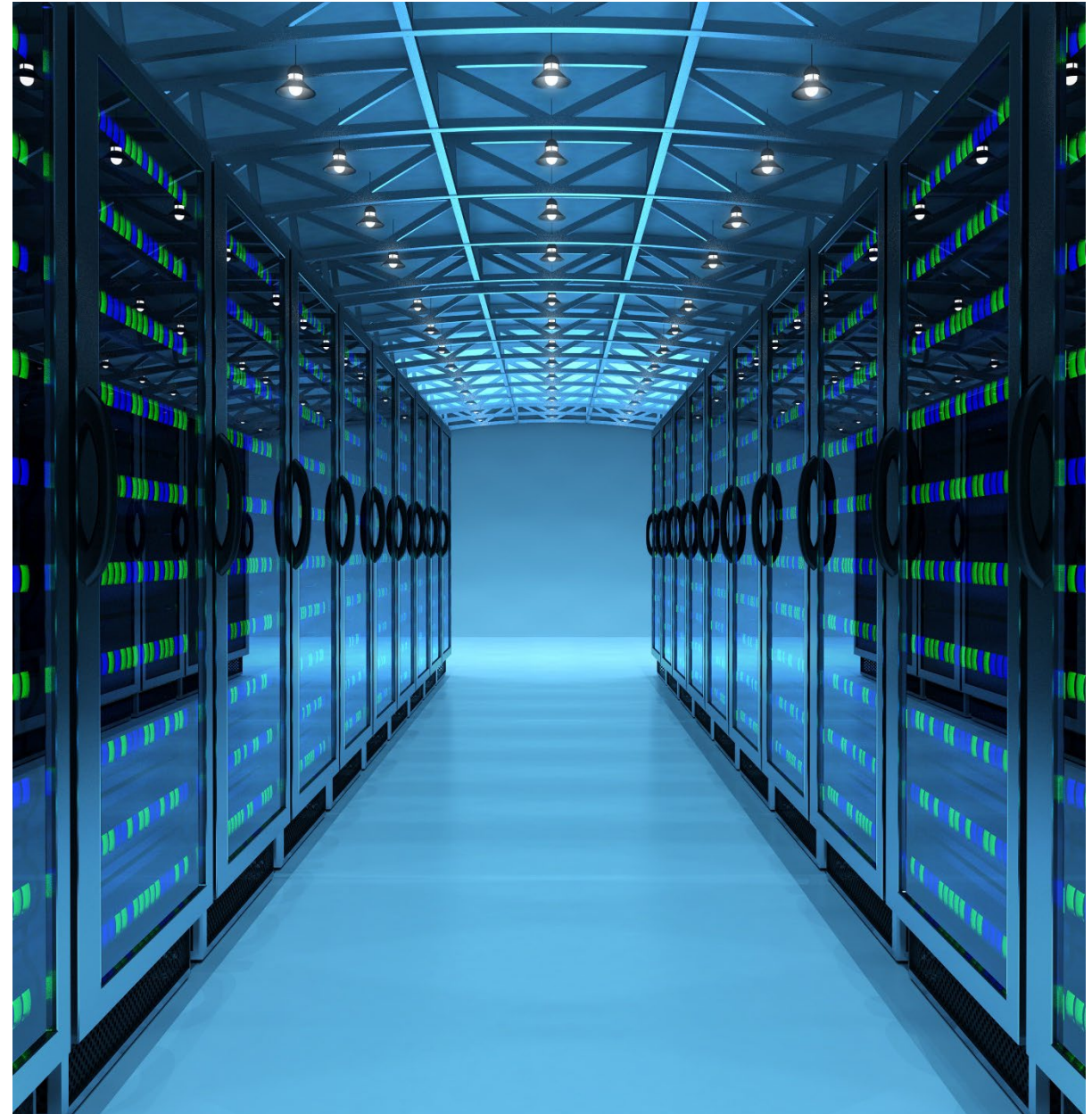


Challenge Task

- This year's challenge focuses on online news recommendation, addressing both the technical and **normative challenges** [...].¹
- [I]nvestigating the effects of recommender systems on the news flow, and whether they resonate with **editorial values**.¹
- The challenge's objective is to rank the candidate articles based on the user's **personal preferences**.²

¹ RecSys Website: <https://recsys.acm.org/recsys24/challenge/>

² Challenge Website: <https://www.recsyschallenge.com/2024/>

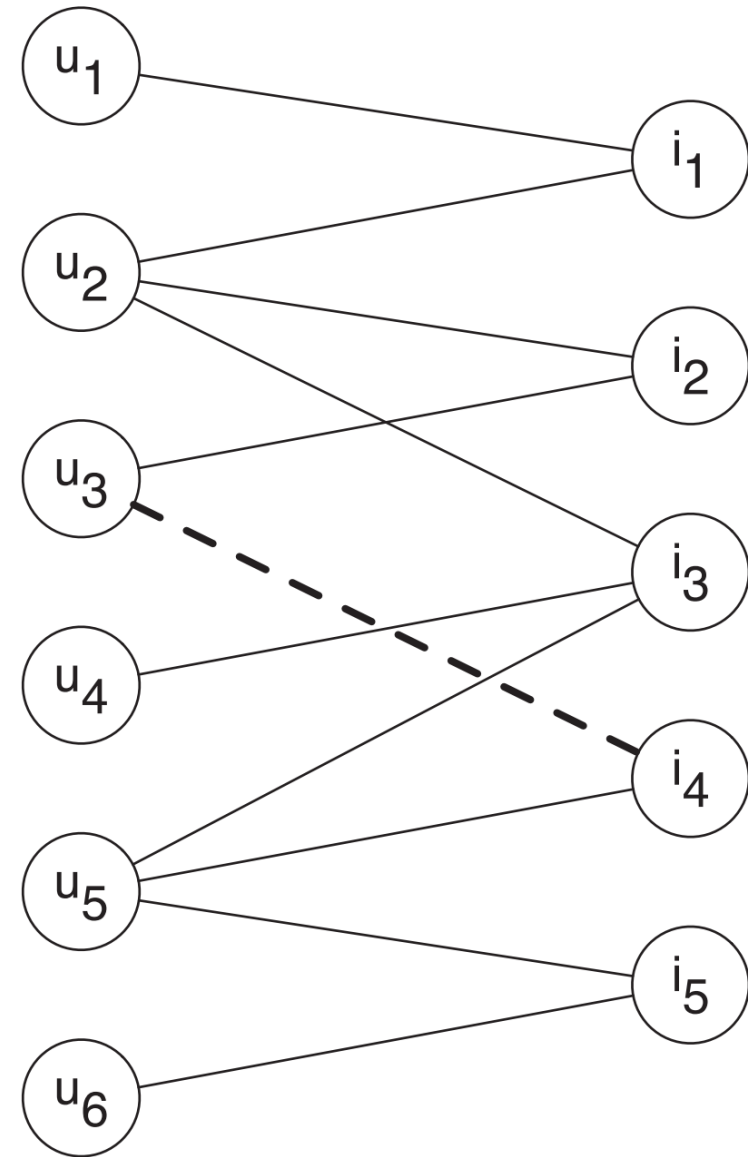


Random Walks

- Excellent accuracy-diversity trade-off.³
- Graph-based approach,⁴ where you...
 - connect users (u_n) and articles (i_n)
 - pick a user and walk across the graph
 - stop at random items and create edge

³Blockbusters and Wallflowers: Accurate, Diverse, and Scalable Recommendations with Random Walks: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/abs/10.1145/2792838.2800180>

⁴Updatable, Accurate, Diverse, and Scalable Recommendations for Interactive Applications: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/2955101>

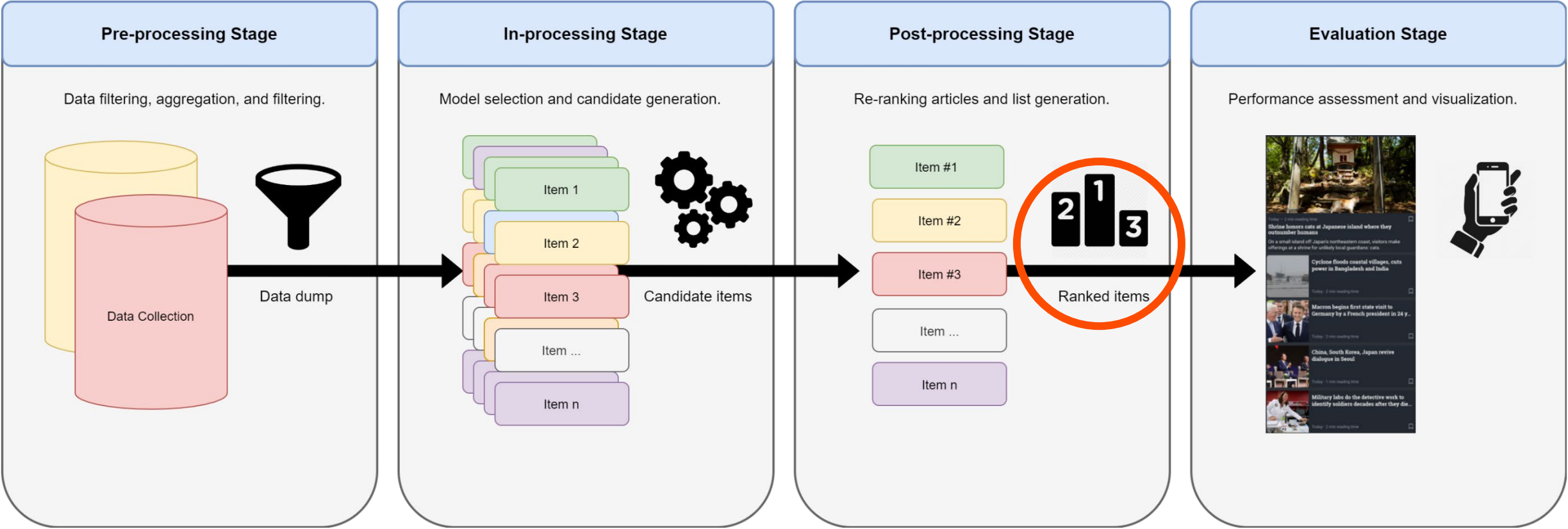


Results Overview

Model	AUC	MRR	NDCG@5	ILD*	NOV*	SER*
Random Walks	0.5005	0.3167	0.3505	0.7549	<u>11.101</u>	<u>0.8069</u>
EB Baseline	0.5684	0.3517	0.3951	<u>0.8402</u>	3.071	0.7915
Top 3 (AVG)	<u>0.7643</u>	<u>0.5501</u>	<u>0.6117</u>	0.6255	5.771	0.7568

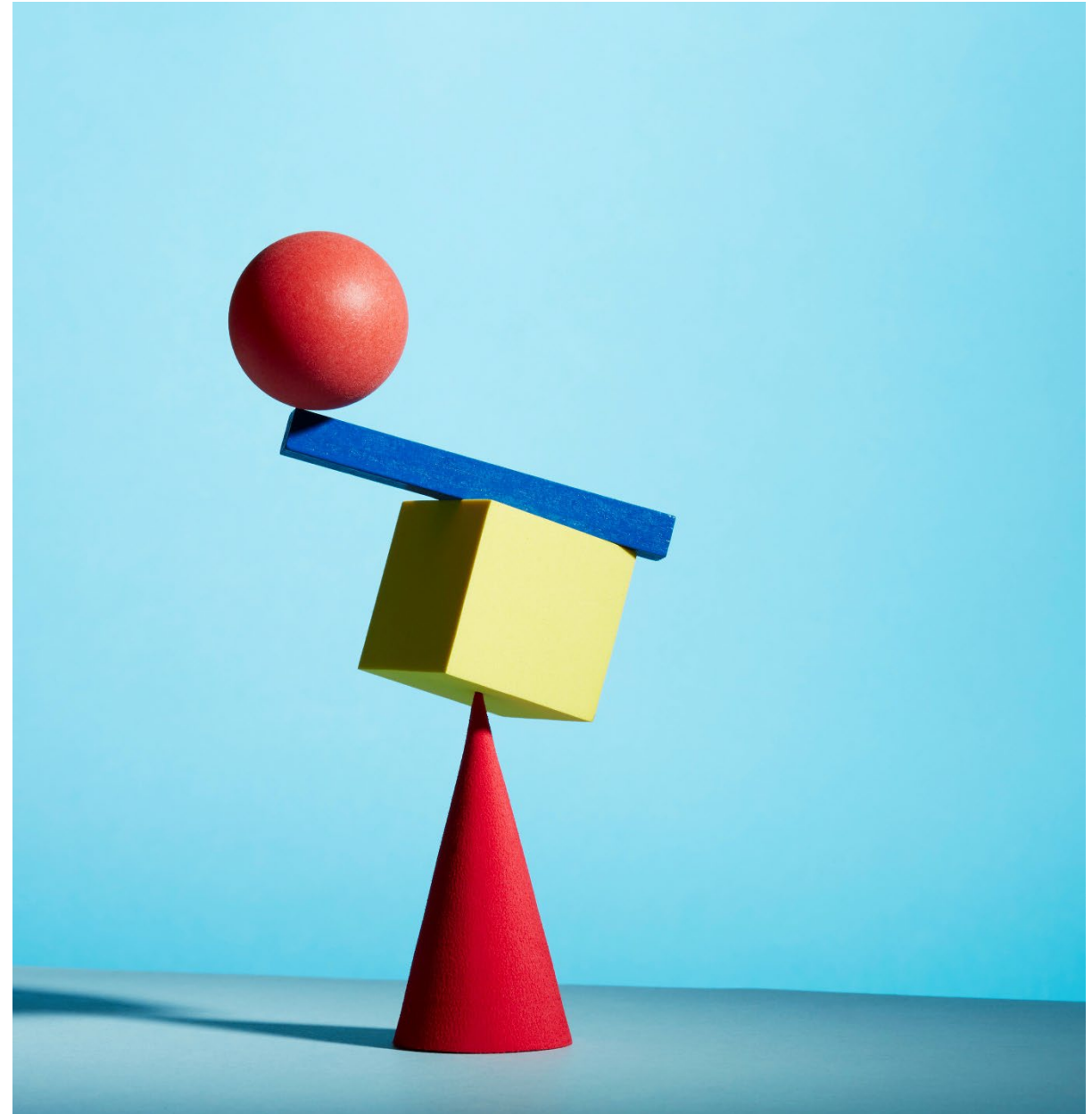
* Beyond-accuracy objectives

Challenge Limitations



Challenge Limitations (Cont.)

- Better balance normativity and accuracy
- Unclear candidate selection process
- Unaccounted beyond-accuracy objectives
- Limited applicability of normative metrics
- Unaddressed editorial value added and effects



Recommendations

- Beyond-accuracy leaderboards
- Submission evaluation with users
- Streamline setup (platform, metrics etc.)
- Promote inter- and cross-disciplinary work
- Open-source challenge dataset





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